

1. Northern Plains

Q1.

In the upper parts of the Bhangar tract in Uttar Pradesh and Haryana, excessive irrigation causes a white saline crust of sodium/magnesium salts to form on the soil surface. What is this unfertile soil locally called?

- A) Bhur
- B) Reh or Kallar
- C) Chos
- D) Terai

Answer: B) Reh or Kallar

Exam History & Source: UPPCS Prelims 2021 | Haryana HCS 2022 | BPSC 2020
(Never asked in RRB NTPC yet — High Probability)

Detailed Explanation: Over-irrigation in semi-arid Bhangar areas brings underground salts to the top layer via capillary action, rendering the topsoil infertile with a white crust termed **Reh** or **Kallar**. *Bhur* refers to elevated sandy deposits along riverbanks; *Chos* are seasonal torrential streams in the Punjab foothills.

Q2.

Which term refers to the newer, highly fertile alluvial deposits of the Northern Plains that are renewed annually by floodwaters?

- A) Bhangar
- B) Khadar
- C) Kankar
- D) Bhabar

Answer: B) Khadar

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2016 (CBT-1) | SSC CHSL 2020 | MPPSC Prelims 2017

Detailed Explanation: **Khadar** is the young alluvial soil deposited by annual river floods, rich in fine silt and humus, making it extremely fertile. **Bhangar** represents older, terrace-like alluvium lying above flood levels and often contains calcareous nodules called *Kankar*.

Q3.

The fertile land tract known as 'Bari Doab' is situated between which two rivers of the Northern Plains?

- A) Beas and Satluj

- **B)** Ravi and Beas
- **C)** Chenab and Jhelum
- **D)** Ravi and Chenab

Answer: B) Ravi and Beas

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2021 (CBT-2) | Punjab PSC 2020 | SSC CGL 2022

Detailed Explanation: Doabs in the Punjab Plains derive their names from the combination of river names: **Ba** = Beas, **Ri** = River Ravi. Similarly, *Bist Doab* lies between **Beas** and **Satluj**, and *Rachna Doab* lies between **Ravi** and **Chenab**.

2. Peninsular Plateau

Q4.

Which mountain plateau/range serves as a major central watershed and radial drainage hub where the Narmada, Son, and tributaries of the Mahanadi originate?

- **A)** Malwa Plateau
- **B)** Amarkantak (Maikal Range)
- **C)** Bundelkhand Plateau
- **D)** Meghalaya Plateau

Answer: B) Amarkantak (Maikal Range)

Exam History & Source: MPPSC Prelims 2022 | CGPSC 2020 | UPPCS 2019
(Never asked in RRB NTPC yet — High Probability)

Detailed Explanation: **Amarkantak** in the Maikal Range is India's premier example of a **radial drainage pattern**. Rivers radiate out in three distinct directions: Narmada flows west, Son flows north towards the Ganga, and Hasdeo/Mahanadi tributaries flow east.

Q5.

Which mountain pass in the Western Ghats (Sahyadri) connects Mumbai directly to Nashik?

- **A)** Bhor Ghat
- **B)** Thal Ghat
- **C)** Pal Ghat
- **D)** Shencottah Gap

Answer: B) Thal Ghat

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2016 (CBT-2) | MPSC Rajyaseva 2019 | SSC CPO 2020

Detailed Explanation: Both Thal Ghat and Bhore Ghat cross the Western Ghats from Mumbai:

- **Thal Ghat** connects Mumbai to **Nashik / North-East India**.
- **Bhore Ghat** connects Mumbai to **Pune / South-East India**.
- **Pal Ghat** lies further south between Nilgiri and Anaimalai hills, connecting Kerala to Tamil Nadu.

Q6.

The Narmada River flows westward into the Arabian Sea through a rift valley bounded by which two mountain ranges?

- **A)** Aravalli (North) and Vindhya (South)
- **B)** Vindhya (North) and Satpura (South)
- **C)** Satpura (North) and Ajanta (South)
- **D)** Western Ghats (North) and Eastern Ghats (South)

Answer: B) Vindhya (North) and Satpura (South)

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2021 (CBT-1) | MPPSC Prelims 2021 | UPSC CDS 2019

Detailed Explanation: The spatial sequence from North to South is: **Vindhya Range** $\rightarrow$ **Narmada River Rift Valley** $\rightarrow$ **Satpura Range** $\rightarrow$ **Tapi River Rift Valley**. Because these rivers flow through hard basaltic rift valleys with steep gradients, they form estuaries rather than deltas.

Q7.

Famous hill stations like Yercaud are located in which specific hill range of the Eastern Ghats in Tamil Nadu?

- **A)** Nallamala Hills
- **B)** Javadi Hills
- **C)** Shevaroy Hills
- **D)** Cardamom Hills

Answer: C) Shevaroy Hills

Exam History & Source: TNPSC Group 1 2022 | APPSC 2021 | UPSC NDA 2021
(Never asked in RRB NTPC yet — High Probability)

Detailed Explanation: The Eastern Ghats are discontinuous and broken into isolated hill blocks south of the Andhra border. In Tamil Nadu, the **Shevaroy Hills** house the famous hill station Yercaud at an elevation of 1,513 m. **Cardamom Hills** belong to the Western Ghats.

3. Islands & Coasts

Q8.

Which is the largest artificial (man-made) island in India, constructed in 1936 using soil dredged during the deepening of Kochi Port?

- **A)** Pamban Island
- **B)** Willingdon Island
- **C)** Sriharikota Island
- **D)** Abdul Kalam Island

Answer: B) Willingdon Island

Exam History & Source: Kerala PSC 2022 | WBPSA 2021 | TNPSC 2020 (*Never asked in RRB NTPC yet — High Probability*)

Detailed Explanation: Willingdon Island in the Kochi backwaters of Kerala is India's largest artificial island, created under the direction of Sir Robert Bristow and named after Lord Willingdon, the Viceroy of India at the time.

Q9.

Saddle Peak (732 m), the highest elevation point of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, is situated on which specific island?

- **A)** Great Nicobar
- **B)** South Andaman
- **C)** North Andaman
- **D)** Little Andaman

Answer: C) North Andaman

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2016 (CBT-1) | UPSC CSE Prelims 1996 | SSC CGL 2019

Detailed Explanation: Saddle Peak (732 m) is located inside Saddle Peak National Park in **North Andaman**. Candidates often confuse it with Great Nicobar, but the highest peak of the Nicobar group is actually *Mount Thullier* (642 m).

Q10.

Which river flows through a rift valley occupying the central portion of the Chota Nagpur Plateau?

- **A)** Subarnarekha
- **B)** Mahanadi
- **C)** Damodar
- **D)** Son

Answer: C) Damodar

Exam History & Source: RRB NTPC 2021 (CBT-1) | WBPSC WBCS Prelims 2020 | JPSC 2021

Detailed Explanation: The **Damodar River** cuts through the central trough of the Chota Nagpur Plateau from west to east. This rift valley contains over 80% of India's prime metallurgical coal deposits, including the Jharia, Raniganj, and Bokaro coalfields.